

Empathy maps & user journeys

What this tool produces · *A chronological matrix visualizing every touchpoint between the user and the service/space, highlighting specific moments of abandonment, confusion, or success.*

G1 · Proof of Impact

Dimensions

Social / User

Spatial

Preparing the workshop · *Empathy maps & user journeys*

G1 · Proof of Impact

Why this tool matters

Stepping fully into the shoes of the excluded to physically feel the friction of reality, dismantling the arrogance of top-down administrative procedures.

Evidence we produce

A chronological matrix visualizing every touchpoint between the user and the service/space, highlighting specific moments of abandonment, confusion, or success.

Duration & Material

Duration · 1 day of collaborative workshop (following field data collection)

Material · Large paper rolls, sticky notes, pre-compiled ethnographic data, thick markers

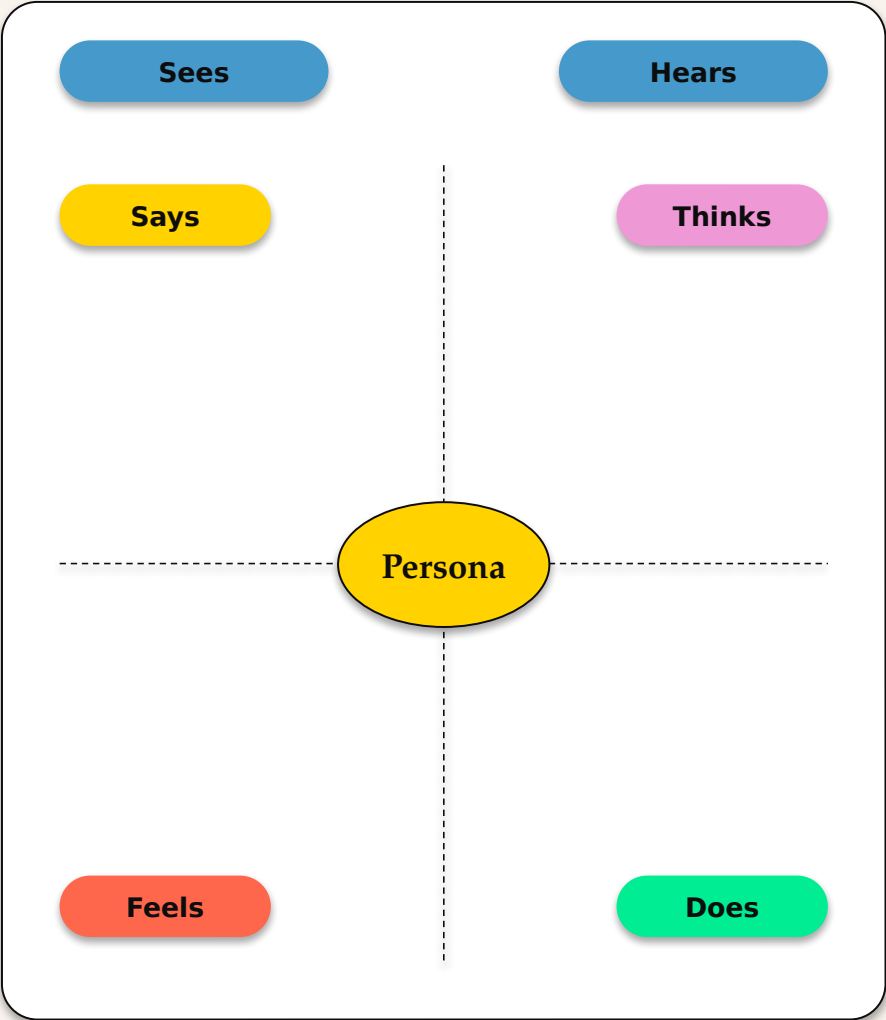
Reference case

The URBACT "Re-Gen" network utilizes empathy mapping and user journey analysis to understand the exact barriers preventing young people from engaging with public spaces. Breaking down interactions step-by-step allows cities to test small-scale actions before committing to massive changes.

Suggested agenda · Brief (10 min) > Method walk-through (15 min) > Animation canvas (60-90 min) > Harvest (20 min)

Empathy quadrants × user journey

Duration
1 day of collaborative workshop (following field data c...



User journey · chronological touchpoints

Phase	P1	P2	P3	P4	P5
User actions					
Emotion					
Touchpoints					
Pain points					
Opportunities					

Surface the moments where emotion drops · that is where to design first.

Harvesting our *learnings*

After running the canvas, capture three layers of insight.

What inspires me

Stand-out signals, surprising stories, ideas to remember

How to apply it here

Concrete adaptations to our context, our team, our constraints

What we need to be autonomous

Skills, allies, resources, decisions still to secure

Each participant fills a copy. Then debrief together to surface patterns and next steps.